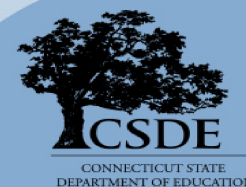


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



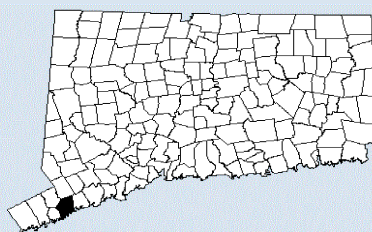
Norwalk School District

Dr. Alexandra Estrella, Superintendent • 203-854-4000 • <https://www.norwalkps.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	24
Enrollment	11,458
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$20,048
Total Expenditures ¹	\$241,701,634

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.5
Male	5,911	51.6	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	15	0.1	0.3
Asian	461	4.0	5.1
Black or African American	1,618	14.1	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	6,184	54.0	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	7	0.1	0.1
Two or More Races	365	3.2	4.3
White	2,808	24.5	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	2,057	18.0	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6,252	54.6	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	1,762	15.4	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	1,520	27.7	*	*
Male	*	*	429	6.9
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	499	31.1	178	10.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,825	29.5	397	6.0
White	518	19.1	70	2.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	670	29.7	134	5.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,887	32.7	480	7.2
Students with Disabilities	637	36.5	198	9.6
District	3,026	26.8	672	5.6
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 3,396

Number of school-based arrests: 25

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwalk School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	807.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	124.1
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	117.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	186.1
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	26.4
School Level	53.3
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	9.0
Support Staff	5.7
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	106.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	84.0
School Nurses	34.3
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	482.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.1	0.1
Asian	30	2.5	1.3
Black or African American	107	8.8	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	112	9.3	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	961	79.4	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.4	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	107	81.1	140	87.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	390	80.4	424	92.2
White	217	91.2	277	93.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	77	59.2	88	79.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	347	84.6	423	91.2
Students with Disabilities	89	69.5	95	64.2
District	760	83.9	887	91.6
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	113	56.8
Emotional Disturbance	62	60.8
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	625	83.1
Other Health Impairment	181	76.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	182	87.1
District	1,181	73.3
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwalk School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	218	1.9	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	104	0.9	1.1
Intellectual Disability	51	0.4	0.6
Learning Disability	756	6.4	6.1
Other Health Impairment	242	2.1	3.3
Other Disabilities	96	0.8	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	243	2.1	1.9
All Disabilities	1,710	14.6	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	79	4.6	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	51	3.0	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$166,659,342	\$13,824	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$19,678,458	\$1,710	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$6,203,637	\$539	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$2,182,001	\$190	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$13,404,360	\$1,165	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$3,702,069	\$322	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$21,280,755	\$1,849	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$8,591,011	\$1,402	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$170
Total	\$241,701,634	\$20,048	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$12,285,802	23.7	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$7,899,549	15.2	10.8
Other Salaries	\$9,265,653	17.9	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$7,522,509	14.5	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$2,627,290	5.1	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$7,603,622	14.7	22.6
Supplies	\$340,221	0.7	0.6
Property Services	\$21,478	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$3,355,564	6.5	6.3
Equipment	\$940,251	1.8	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$10,558	0.0	0.1
Total	\$51,872,498	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		21.5	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	82.6
State	11.0
Federal	5.7
Tuition & Other	0.6

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwalk School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	6	*	6	*	*	*
Asian	239	73.8	238	70.2	105	72.2
Black or African American	781	54.0	780	45.7	337	48.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2,993	55.2	2,974	50.1	1,301	51.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	6	*	6	*	*	*
Two or More Races	159	65.6	159	60.5	56	59.7
White	1,304	72.6	1,301	67.7	553	68.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,309	48.9	1,300	45.2	528	46.6
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	4,179	63.9	4,164	57.9	1,830	59.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,880	55.5	2,864	49.7	1,200	52.2
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,608	65.7	2,600	60.7	1,158	60.8
Students with Disabilities	891	41.5	884	34.5	365	42.4
Students without Disabilities	4,597	64.0	4,580	58.8	1,993	58.9
High Needs	3,578	53.9	3,559	48.4	1,521	51.1
Non-High Needs	1,910	72.4	1,905	67.1	837	66.0
District	5,488	60.3	5,464	54.9	2,358	56.4

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	86.4	84.1	84.6	76.7	3,466	82.4
Curl Up	88.4	88.5	87.9	78.1	3,466	85.1
Push Up	76.7	79.8	73.9	63.4	3,466	72.6
Mile Run/PACER	78.6	77.8	62.0	55.9	3,466	67.5
All Tests - District	64.6	62.9	55.5	46.6	3,466	56.5
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwalk School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	153	85.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	440	84.3
White	263	94.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	130	70.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	568	83.8
Students with Disabilities	129	69.0
District	916	87.8
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	97.1	331	35.1
Male	*	322	34.6
Non-Binary	*	0	*
Black or African American	93.2	56	19.1
Hispanic or Latino	95.4	221	23.4
White	96.4	326	60.9
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	87.6	10	4.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	95.0	208	23.8
Students with Disabilities	79.3	16	5.8
District	95.4	653	34.8
State	95.0		43.5

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	75.8	83.4
Male	61.8	78.3
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	64.8	81.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	60.3	75.0
White	80.0	84.9
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	38.5	69.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61.7	75.5
Students with Disabilities	45.9	77.5
District	68.8	81.1
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwalk School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	60.3	75	40.2	50	80.5	64.2
	High Needs Students	53.9	75	35.9	50	71.9	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	54.9	75	36.6	50	73.2	58.6
	High Needs Students	48.4	75	32.3	50	64.5	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	56.4	75	37.6	50	75.2	61.4
	High Needs Students	51.1	75	34.1	50	68.1	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	57.1%	100%	57.1	100	57.1	60.4%
	High Needs Students	54.7%	100%	54.7	100	54.7	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	62.6%	100%	62.6	100	62.6	65.2%
	High Needs Students	59.4%	100%	59.4	100	59.4	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	63.3%	100%	31.6	50	63.3	64.9%
	Oral	59.2%	100%	29.6	50	59.2	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	26.8%	<=5%	6.5	50	12.9	23.7%
	High Needs Students	32.1%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	87.9%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	34.8%	75%	23.2	50	46.5	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		89.9%	94%	47.8	50	95.6	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		87.8%	94%	93.4	100	93.4	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		90.9%	94%	96.7	100	96.7	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		68.8%	75%	91.7	100	91.7	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		98.4% 56.5%	75%	37.6	50	75.3	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		53.0%	60%	44.1	50	88.3	52.4%
Accountability Index				1002.7	1450	69.2	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	72.4	53.9	18.5	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	67.1	48.4	18.7	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	66.0	51.1	15.0	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	90.9%	3.1%	10.2%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	97.8
	High Needs Students	97.2
Math	All Students	97.4
	High Needs Students	96.8
Science	All Students	96.8
	High Needs Students	96.2

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 43.5

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwalk School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

In 2021-22, NPS rolled out a new strategic plan, Future Ready, which reflects the needs and desires of families, students and the community. The plan focuses on 6 priority goals: strengthening student success plans; developing a 3-5 year facilities plan; streamlining human resources, finance and business operations; cultivating instructional leadership; increasing student opportunities and ensuring all students have access to high quality programs and support; and providing families with equitable opportunities to access resources and programs.

Improving programs and services for students with disabilities was a focus under the strategic plan. Work included the expansion of specialized learning programs with an emphasis on inclusive instruction, high quality IEP training for all special ed and related services staff, and implementing SRBI at K-8 schools. A parent satisfaction survey identified trends, strengths and areas for improvement. Norwalk's commitment to engagement, inclusion and access was highlighted this year with the opening of the NPS Family Center. A centralized location for family-facing school services, the NPS Family Center helps establish lasting relationships and meaningful family engagement throughout a student's academic career. Open year-round, including evening hours every Thursday, the Family Center provides easy access to register students, get information, voice concerns and resolve issues. Bilingual staff are on site to assist families and provide language testing. NPS's special education ombudsperson, fluent in both English and Spanish, organizes support groups, and helps connect families with services and programs. By collaborating with other city agencies and community partners, the centralized location also streamlines services for families across the city.

Regular communication includes district and school websites, an auto call system, text messaging option and e-blasts. District social media accounts include Facebook, Twitter and Instagram, an NPS en Español Facebook page. Social media accounts for schools also rolled out. Video communication was emphasized, including messages from the superintendent to families in both English and Spanish. District e-newsletters are sent to families every 2 weeks in English and Spanish. Schools and the district ensure that translators are available to families at conferences, parent meetings and open houses. Board of Ed meetings are live streamed on the NPS YouTube channel, with options for Spanish and Haitian-Creole, and past meetings are available on demand. Families have access to a Parent Portal to track student work and progress. Dr. Estrella also values student voices, convening an informal high school student advisory panel throughout for feedback.

To deter truancy, families are notified of student absences via School Messenger, and school administrators reach out to families directly to address ongoing issues. Parents can monitor attendance through the Parent Portal. The district convenes an Attendance Committee specifically to review attendance and schools reach out directly to students not attending regularly. This year, NPS also continued our Twilight Academy to serve high school students struggling as a result of family, financial, childcare or work obligations, giving these students an alternate route to graduation.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

In 2021-22, NPS continued its comprehensive Equity in Education initiative, working with Dr. Edward Fergus of Temple University. Training on diversity, equity and implicit bias was conducted throughout the year for school and district leaders, as well as the Board of Education. Under our deputy superintendent for excellence, equity and inclusion, family workshops on racism were conducted, and My Brother's Keeper and My Sister's Keeper programs were launched for students of color.

To address growing enrollment, a comprehensive school building program is under way. Renovations are nearing completion at Jefferson Elementary, a neighborhood school that serves a densely populated area. Planning is underway for construction at other schools, including at Cranbury Elementary and a new building for Norwalk High. Most recently, city leaders have reached an agreement to purchase property for a new school in the South Norwalk neighborhood. In a public session held by the superintendent, community members aligned around a schoolwide enrichment model for the school that will incorporate social justice and financial literacy, as well as global citizenship, arts and languages.

In addition to neighborhood schools, NPS has expanded choice program options, including Montessori, an intra-district Bank Street magnet, and a dual-language elementary. The Center for Global Studies offers studies in Japanese, Chinese and Arabic. In partnership with IBM and NCC, students can earn both a HS diploma and associate's degree at P-TECH Norwalk. NPS also offers an IB diploma program, and health sciences, digital media and marine science pathways. This year, the Board of Education approved the roll out of school choice across all Norwalk middle schools, beginning in 2023-24. The district also continues to develop other pathways and choice options, and has received approval to develop IB primary years and middle years programs. The Seal of Biliteracy is awarded to graduates demonstrating language proficiency.

Recruitment and hiring practices encourage candidates from all backgrounds and ensure fair and equitable treatment, in alignment with our minority recruitment policy. Career fairs and recruitment efforts reach beyond the local area to identify qualified educators.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Norwalk School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Norwalk Public Schools procedures for distribution of resources strives to ensure that each school receives an equitable level of material and financial resources. School Governance Councils operate at every school, providing additional opportunities for parents, staff and community members to advise district and school leaders.

NPS operates under a Student Based Budgeting system, which provides a per pupil expenditure based on the student population numbers in each school. School principals have been trained in Student Based Budgeting so that they have the knowledge needed to allocate those resources according to the needs of their individual schools.

Staff members are assigned based on the number of students and programs operating in that individual school, in accordance with contractual class size limits. Additional equipment, textbooks and supplies are purchased centrally on behalf of schools.